
ANIMALHACK 2026

Team Q&A Prep Sheet

ResCutes

*Internal briefing for the presentation slot
(~10 minutes total | ~3 minutes Q&A)*

Share with teammates privately. Do not publish on the public GitHub judges browse.

*Purpose: help judges understand the work, the tradeoffs, and how it serves animal welfare. Listen first.
Answer honestly. Offer a demo when it helps. We are guests in their review.*

Team: Yuan Andrei Mariano | Mark Adrian Bautista | Raphael Edrian Tan | Ivan Muñoz Untalan

Live demo: <https://rescutes.vercel.app/>

Repo: <https://github.com/Rapnunu/ResCutes>

0. Format reminder

Item	Fact
Total slot	~10 minutes (talk + Q&A)
Q&A budget	~3 minutes
Submit + register	Devpost + presentation form by 12pm Sept 12, 2026 EST
Present	Sept 13, 2026 EST
Must show	Public link with actual outcome (live app and/or GitHub), not only a proposal
Live demo	https://rescutes.vercel.app/
Repo	https://github.com/Rapnunu/ResCutes
Track fit	Supporting animal shelters, rescues, and foster programs

Judging criteria (keep in mind; do not force into every sentence): Impact | Creativity & innovation | Execution | Presentation. Respect the organizers' process and the judges' time. Short answers leave room for follow-ups.

1. How we answer (team rules)

1. One lead speaker answers first (about 15-25 seconds). Others add only if asked, or if the lead invites them by name.
2. Structure: Claim -> brief proof -> offer to show. Example: "Urgency is rule-based and explainable: injury, danger, vulnerability, and wait time. We can open a high-urgency case if that would help."
3. If you don't know: "We haven't measured that yet. Here's what we did check: ..." Never invent metrics or shelter endorsements.
4. If the demo glitches: stay calm. Use seeded roles, README screenshots, or narrate while a teammate recovers the tab. Thank the judges for their patience.
5. Never say "AI built this" or "Cursor did it." Say "we built," "we implemented," "our team."
6. Keep answers short. Aim to leave space for 2-4 questions.
7. Credit the ecosystem. Informal rescuers, Facebook groups, and WhatsApp threads already save animals. We add operational structure; we do not replace community care.

Suggested coverage (fill in before the call)

Theme	Who owns answers	Backup
Problem / Philippines context / impact	_____	_____

Theme	Who owns answers	Backup
Urgency scoring + shelter routing	_____	_____
Mobile vs web / roles / demo path	_____	_____
Stack / auth / DB / deploy	_____	_____
Limits / next steps / ethics	_____	_____

2. Short team pitch

ResCutes helps coordinate Philippine animal rescue from a citizen report through shelter intake, vet clearance, and adoption readiness. Citizens and rescuers use a mobile PWA; staff and vets use a web dashboard. Same Next.js app, Neon database, and auth. Beyond collecting forms, we score urgency with readable reasons, and suggest shelters by capacity, capability, species, distance, and workload. We built this as a working demo for evaluation, and we still have polish and real-world onboarding ahead.

3. Impact questions

Q: Why does this matter? / Who is this for?

A: Animals and people get stuck between social posts and informal chats, and shelters sometimes receive animals they cannot house or treat well. Our users are citizens, volunteer rescuers, shelter staff, and vets. The track we aimed at is shelters, rescues, and foster/adoption support.

Q: What is the scale of the problem?

A: We do not claim national statistics we did not measure. What we see locally: reports scatter across social media, DMs, and calls, which can mean duplicates, delayed response, mismatched shelters, and lost handoff details. ResCutes tries to keep one auditable case thread from report toward clearance. We would need partner data before claiming population-level impact.

Q: How is this different from Facebook groups / WhatsApp?

A: Those channels matter a lot for awareness and mobilizing help. We respect that. Where we try to add value is operations: roles and permissions, a case status pipeline, urgency with explanations, capacity-aware shelter suggestions, medical clearance before adoption, and a map of field cases and shelters. Chat alone rarely shows which shelter still has space and can treat a trapped nursing dog.

Q: Will shelters actually adopt this?

A: Fair question. Today this is a demo-ready ops tool for hackathon evaluation, not a signed shelter pilot. Next barriers would include onboarding real shelter data, training, and better support for weak connectivity in the field. Judges can walk the full path on the live demo with five roles.

Q: How do you help adoption / foster specifically?

A: After medical clearance, animals can move toward adoption or foster readiness. Staff review applications on the web; citizens and rescuers can browse or swipe on mobile. Our view is that rescue work is unfinished until the animal has a safer next step.

4. Creativity & innovation questions

Q: What is innovative here? Is this just a CRUD app?

A: Much of any ops tool is CRUD, and we own that. Two pieces go further: (1) Explainable urgency (injury, environmental danger, vulnerability, wait after verify) -> score 0-100, level, and plain-language factors. (2) Shelter suggestions weighted by capability 35%, capacity 25%, species 20%, distance 15%, workload 5% - each with reasons and warnings. We are happy to show either engine live.

Q: How does urgency scoring work? Give an example.

A: Points add up (cap 100). Example: severe injury 28 + traffic 25 + nursing 18 = 71 -> High; wait time after verification can raise it further. Staff can override with a written reason when field judgment differs. The goal is transparency for volunteers, not a black box.

Factor	Max	Memorable examples
Injury	35	moderate 20, critical 35
Danger	30	traffic 25, trapped 30
Vulnerability	20	juvenile 12, nursing 18
Wait after verified	15	rises with hours waiting

Q: Why not use ML / computer vision for injury?

A: A deliberate MVP choice. Transparent rules are easier for staff to audit and explain. Vision models would need labeled Philippine street-animal data and careful trust calibration. We prioritized explainability and a working end-to-end path first. We are open to learning from stronger approaches later.

Q: How do you avoid sending animals to the wrong shelter?

A: Suggestions check species accepted, free capacity, needed capabilities (for example wound care or emergency care), distance, and workload. Recommendations surface gaps ("no capacity", "missing emergency surgery") so staff are not guessing from a static list. Final choice stays with people who know the ground.

Q: Map / Philippines angle?

A: Mapbox maps centered on a Metro Manila-style demo; a Philippines shelter directory (dozens of listings, verified plus OSM-sourced partners). Seeded cases use local street contexts so the story matches where we built it. We treat directory data carefully and would verify further with real partners.

5. Execution questions

Q: Does it actually work? Can you show us?

A: Yes - please try <https://rescutes.vercel.app/> with the demo roles (demo1234). The repo also has Vitest and Playwright tests. After an internal QA pass and fixes (create routes, validation, RBAC mobile gate, narrow layouts), a post-remediation re-audit scored 90/100 on 8 Sep 2026 (baseline 64/100). That is our own hardening checklist, not an external certification. Residual polish remains on medical tabs and map legend at very small widths.

Workflow in one sentence each

1. Citizen reports on mobile (photo, location, phone).
2. Staff verify or reject (reason required).
3. Urgency is computed; staff may override with a reason.
4. Rescuer is assigned -> accept or decline -> mark secured.
5. Shelter is suggested -> handoff -> intake.
6. Vet exam -> medical clearance -> adoption / foster path.

Q: Why two interfaces?

A: Field work fits a phone PWA (report, map, assignments). Ops needs tables, medical queue, dispatch, and adoption review. Same codebase, role-gated: staff and vets are redirected away from /mobile; citizens do not use the web ops dashboard.

Q: What is the tech stack?

A: Next.js 15, React 19, TypeScript, Tailwind, Neon Auth + Neon Postgres (Drizzle), Mapbox, Zod validation, Vitest + Playwright, deployed on Vercel (Singapore region for PH latency).

Q: How do you handle auth / data safety?

A: Neon Auth sessions; roles enforced server-side, not only by hiding UI. Reporter contact is for authorized field roles. Photos use Vercel Blob when configured. Demo uses seeded accounts. A real public launch would need org onboarding and a stricter PII policy. We take that seriously.

Q: What if the demo looks empty or broken?

A: Use seeded accounts; hard refresh. Demo data lives in Neon. If a case modal fails, open Rescue Cases -> full case page, or switch role (staff vs rescuer). README screenshots show the UI. We can narrate while a teammate recovers the tab. Thank you for bearing with us if something hiccups live.

Demo path to rehearse (~90 seconds)

1. Landing -> Login as citizen@rescutes.demo -> /mobile/report (show fields).
2. Logout -> staff@rescutes.demo -> /rescue-cases -> open a case -> Verify / Dispatch / Urgency.
3. Optional: /shelters capacity, /medical queue, /adoption.
4. Logout -> rescuer@rescutes.demo -> map layers + assignment accept.

Password for all: demo1234

6. Hard questions (stay calm and honest)

Q: This looks ambitious. What is done vs planned?

A: Done and demoable: report -> verify -> assign -> secure -> handoff / intake -> medical clearance -> adoption surfaces; urgency and routing engines; role gates; live deploy. Honest gaps: not a signed shelter pilot; mobile still has polish items from QA; we want CI smoke tests on a dedicated test DB so demo data stays clean. We would rather under-claim than over-promise.

Q: Did you copy another product (Petfinder, etc.)?

A: Adoption boards already exist and serve an important need. Our focus is field rescue coordination before listing. Urgency plus capacity and capability routing into intake is the gap we targeted for informal Philippine rescue networks. We learned from existing tools; we are not claiming to replace them.

Q: Privacy / reporter safety?

A: Contact (phone / email) is for authorized roles so rescuers can reach reporters. Location can be approximate in public map contexts. We would strengthen consent and retention before a real public launch.

Q: Offline / low connectivity?

A: Mobile is PWA-oriented; some draft resilience exists for interrupted reporting. Full offline sync is a next step, not a claim for today.

Q: Cost / who pays?

A: Hackathon MVP on Vercel + Neon + Mapbox free or developer tiers. Real shelters would need a lightweight SaaS or NGO-sponsored model. We have not locked pricing; impact and trust come first.

Q: Ethics - does tech delay care?

A: Our intent is the opposite: faster triage and better shelter fit so animals bounce less between facilities. Urgency rises with wait time after verification so stalled cases surface. We welcome critique if any step adds friction; that would be a bug for us to fix.

Q: Why should you win / which award fits?

A: Stay humble. Do not lobby for a trophy. If asked, map work to criteria: Social Impact (fragmented reports -> coordinated pipeline); Innovation (explainable urgency + routing with reasons); Execution (live multi-role demo, tests, internal QA 90/100); Team Work (four CS Data Science students, shared mobile + web codebase). Awards are the judges' decision. Our job is to present clearly and answer honestly.

7. Team / process questions

Q: Who are you?

A: BS Computer Science (Data Science specialization). Team: Yuan Andrei Mariano, Mark Adrian Bautista, Raphael Edrian Tan, Ivan Muñoz Untalan.

Q: How did you divide work?

A: Stay truthful to how you actually worked. Safe phrasing: "We shared one repo (main / develop), paired on workflows (rescue, medical, maps, adoption), and integrated against one Neon demo database." Do not invent titles you cannot defend.

Q: What would you build in another week?

A: (1) More polish on smallest phone frames (medical tabs + map legend). (2) CI smoke tests on a dedicated Neon branch. (3) Re-run full QA (including XSS create re-check) with evidence beyond the current 90/100.

8. Pocket lines (calm and specific)

Trigger	Line
"So what?"	One case thread from street report toward a cleared, adoption-ready animal.
"Show us."	Live demo, five roles, password demo1234. Happy to walk it with you.
"What's new?"	Explainable urgency, plus shelter ranking with reasons and warnings.
"Is it real?"	Deployed app, GitHub, automated tests, and an internal QA re-audit (90/100 after fixes).
"Philippines?"	Built around local informal rescue patterns; PH shelter directory + Metro Manila-style maps.
"Just students?"	Yes - a student team. The demo is what we ask judges to try themselves.

9. Closing if time runs out

Thank you for the questions. We're glad to open the live demo after - citizen report on mobile, staff dispatch on web, same case ID end to end. Links are in our Devpost and README. We appreciate AnimalHack for the chance to present.

10. Pre-flight checklist (night before)

- [] Devpost submitted + presentation Google Form done (before 12pm Sept 12 EST)
- [] Public link works; landing reachable; demo accounts tested
- [] Two people can share screen; backup hotspot ready
- [] Browser tabs pre-opened: landing, login, mobile, rescue-cases, shelters, medical
- [] Password remembered: demo1234
- [] This sheet on a second device (not the demo screen)
- [] Agreed who answers Impact / Innovation / Execution / Stack
- [] Practiced 10-minute talk ending by minute 7 so Q&A is not crushed
- [] Tone check: grateful, specific, no invented metrics

11. Practice prompts (drill each other)

Have a teammate fire these cold; answer in 25 seconds or less:

1. What problem do you solve in one sentence?
2. Give a concrete urgency score example.
3. How do you choose a shelter?
4. Why mobile and web?
5. What is your weakest claim today?
6. Show me where a rescuer accepts an assignment.
7. How is this animal-welfare work, not only software?
8. What did QA still flag after remediation?
9. How do you speak about Facebook / WhatsApp without dismissing them?
10. If a judge asks why you should win, how do you answer without lobbying?

Internal team prep for AnimalHack 2026. Prefer humility over hype. Prefer a working demo over a perfect speech. Prefer thanking the judges over arguing with them.
